

BSG Statistics Department Monthly Newsletter



*Year of Soaring Higher Toward
a Youthful Soka Gakkai Worldwide*

Greetings from BSG Chairperson



My dearest comrades of BSG Statistics Department,

I would like to extend my heartfelt wishes for the New Year-Year of Soaring Higher toward a Youthful Soka Gakkai Worldwide. My deepest gratitude and appreciation to each one of you for your sincere and painstaking efforts in maintaining statistics in BDS month after month and taking care of each life in your care. I am sure all your unseen efforts will bring about visible rewards as promised by Nichiren Daishonin. Please be confident that your efforts as statistics incharges will be the victory of all your members and all your units as we advance towards one million membership of BSG by 2030.

This year we announced the BSG membership goal of 350,000 cherished lives with all areas striving forward and soaring higher with their respective membership goals. I believe your contribution and role as statistics incharges is significant this year in achieving these goals, especially in the districts.

Ikeda Sensei writes:

"I vowed to achieve Mr. Toda's cherished goal of 750,000 households....I launched a fresh groundswell for kosen-rufu from

the frontlines of my district, sharing my mentor's resolve. I was utterly determined to be a district leader directly connected to my mentor" (Guidelines for Kosen-rufu, Victory, and Happiness, p. 3).

Ikeda Sensei started his quest and struggle toward 750,000 households from his district connected to his mentor Toda Sensei. Now you as statistics incharges can truly play a major role in striving in the frontlines in cherishing and taking care of each life connected to our eternal mentor Ikeda Sensei. Based on this year's activity focus on Daimoku, Home visits and Shakubuku (DHS), let us do our best to create happy and joyful districts this year and report it to our mentor.

This year let's focus on fostering trust and genuine connections. In all his travels for peace, Sensei equally embraced each individual he met, cherishing each encounter and building the bridge of friendship and trust.

Ikeda Sensei says, "It's important to encourage members to chant and share Buddhism with others, but you first need to open others' hearts and befriend them if you want to win their sympathy and understanding.... Everything starts from opening up and coming to know and understand each other as people" ('High Seas', NHR-22, p. 272-73).

Let us be compassionate individuals, who can impart heartfelt encouragement and support. Let us do home visits and shakubuku together with our friends and new members and strengthen our network of friendship.

Lastly, I would like to share Sensei's poem in appreciation to the statistics incharges:

*"You, with a lofty and noble mission,
I pray that you will be embraced by benefits
and enjoy good health"*

(BSG Statistics Department Handbook, p. xx)

With my best regards

Vishesh Gupta ●●●

**STRENGTHENING THE CASTLE OF KOSEN-RUFU WITH DHS:
OUR MISSION IN 2025**

Dear Mathematicians of Happiness-Valiant Statistics Incharges of BSG,

We would like to extend our heartfelt New Year wishes for the Year 2025-Year of Soaring Higher Toward a Youthful Soka Gakkai Worldwide. Heartiest congratulations on the successful New Year's Gongyo meetings! We are inspired by the reports shared by many of you. It is because of the indomitable spirit and efforts of all of you that we have been able to keep a record of the countless lives empowered through Daishonin's Buddhism and will soar further higher in this year.

As statistics incharges, let us advance towards our target of 3,50,000 members in 2025. We play a crucial role in achieving our area goals and to do so, we must embrace the three pillars of DHS-Daimoku, Home Visits, and Shakubuku as our guiding force.

Sensei says, "Daimoku is the foundation of our faith. Mentor and disciple chant with a shared commitment for the realization of kosen-rufu; fellow members, too, chant with unity of purpose, or the spirit of 'many in body, one in mind'. Such daimoku is the starting point for new progress" (The Vow of the Ikeda Kayokai, p. 4).

With shared commitment, let's unite, chant together, and support each other

in strengthening our determination. Let us also home visit each member and chant with them with deep conviction, knowing each encounter has the power to transform lives. Embracing the spirit of the Ganges, let's treat each life as a precious droplet, tracking their transfers, attendance, participation, and victories. Through these actions, let us build a mighty river of capable individuals to fortify the castle of kosen-rufu.

Another key character of statistics incharges is to make dialogue and shakubuku our way of life. Once we introduce new lives, we must support them with untiring care, connect them to their districts and guide them till they gain the confidence to stand on their own. Our goal is to help them build a solid foundation for victory through regular home visits, teaching Gongyo, and encouraging their participation in meetings.

Sensei determined as a disciple, "I'll do it. I'll do it no matter what" ('India', NHR-3, p. 147).

Imbibing this spirit, let us use DHS as our sword, to realize our eternal vow and to fulfil our promise to our mentor. This year, let us build a BSG of 3,50,000. Let us do it, let us do it no matter what!

- By ABACUS Editorial Team ●●●

BSG STATISTICS DEPARTMENT MOTTO

"With the heart of oneness of mentor and disciple, we cherish each life as Bodhisattva of the Earth and strive diligently towards the dynamic and eternal advancement of Kosen-rufu."

CONFIDENTLY SHARING OUR CONVICTIONS AND PERSONAL EXPERIENCES IN FAITH

Prayer is the key. The important thing is to pray to the Gohonzon with steadfast determination. There is nothing more powerful than prayer.

This is not mere theory. Without prayer, all our efforts will ultimately get us nowhere. But when we wholeheartedly pray and talk to people, things will definitely begin to change.

Also, everyone's timing is different. The time will someday come for that person to awaken to the correct teaching of Buddhism. If we pray for them, it will definitely happen.

We must not be impatient. Please show patience and forbearance. Patience is essential for victory.

And when people don't respond the way we hope, aren't they giving us a wonderful opportunity to chant lots of daimoku?!

The benefit is ours to enjoy. No effort that we make for kosen-rufu is ever wasted. There is no such thing as a "loss." Soka Gakkai activities bring nothing but gain.



The important thing is to talk to them with sincerity. The person may be hearing about Buddhism for the first time. Therefore, it's important that you are genuine and openhearted, speaking in an easy-to-understand way.

Talk to them confidently about the greatness of Buddhism and faith. Tell them about living a life of conviction. Explain to them how you have forged a life of value while enjoying proof of the power of your Buddhist practice and how you are advancing with courage and boundless hope for the future.

Ultimately, it all comes down to you proudly sharing your conviction and experience in faith. Doing so plants the seeds of happiness and hope in your friends' lives. These seeds will undoubtedly take root, bud, and eventually flower. Until then, it is enough that you continue chanting and wait for that time to come.

*(The Wisdom for Creating Happiness and Peace,
Part-2 Human Revolution, p. 298-300)* ●●●

ETERNAL GUIDELINE FOR THE STATISTICS DEPARTMENT

"A membership card is not a piece of paper; it is the life of one person. In it, the life pulsates, the personality is contained, and the drama of awakening in faith and rebirth is played out. There exist the human-to-human bonds of warm trust. Because we have been cherishing each person to the utmost, we see the magnificent development of the Soka Gakkai today."

- Daisaku Ikeda (December 15, 2002)



STRENGTHENING BONDS AND FAITH: MY MISSION IN MYSTIC DISTRICT

Kiran Dixit

**District Statistics Incharge,
East Delhi Area**



**Scan to listen to
the experience**

I joined the world of Soka in 2017 after a neighbour invited me to a New Year's Gongyo meeting. Despite my husband's lack of support and life's challenges, I began practicing. In 2020, I faced a life-threatening ectopic pregnancy and 12 cysts, but my consistent practice helped me recover. Though medications and excessive weight caused severe body aches, I stayed determined to advance kosen-rufu.

As I assumed leadership responsibility in my district, I also started supporting with the statistics. I quickly learnt working on MDS and completed all responsibilities, like marking attendance on the same day of meetings, responding to transfers, etc. As responsibilities grew, so did the devilish functions. My husband lost his job, and I experienced another complicated pregnancy. However, I remained focused on my mission as a statistics incharge. I attended All India training on BDS modules and aligned myself with other statistics incharges. I generated a member list and started praying for each member.

I always mark attendance promptly, initiate transfers and ensure that the members are connected to their new districts; I also monitor the BDS regularly for incoming transfers and invite them to meetings. I update information of the new members on BDS and assist them

log into the BSG Trailblazer portal. I keep track of VC and FDT subscription reports and inform members about renewals. My co district statistics incharge and I have a strong bond, and we work harmoniously. As a result, during the last appointment cycle, we successfully fostered all division leadership and appointed eight leaders. Our district has 96 members, and I have personal connect with each member. Our last Gosho meeting saw an increase of 10 in the attendance. During the July 3rd WD campaign, we were able to create a wave of encouragement and 28 WDs out of 50 in our district attended the WD meeting. I also visited each YWD, encouraged their participation in meetings by giving responsibilities. Consequently, our YWD membership has grown from 1 to 13.

Nichiren Daishonin writes: "Unseen virtue brings about visible reward" (WND-1, p. 940). Through all my earnest causes, I have been able to transform my karma. I lost 22kgs and now maintain a good health. Our financial situation also changed, with my husband securing a job with significant raise. Despite hectic schedule, I am joyfully nurturing both my family at home and the Gakkai family. I am determined to take full responsibility of kosen-rufu and chant abundant daimoku for the happiness and victories of every member. ●●●

Mathematicians of the Month

Timely attendance marking is an expression of reporting victory to Ikeda Sensei by statistics incharges!

Introducing the zones where all the districts marked the 'Discussion Meeting' attendance in the month of December 2024.

We accord these zones as 'MATHEMATICIANS OF THE MONTH' for December 2024.

MATHEMATICIANS OF THE MONTH

Delhi East

Ananda - Lotus
Expressway - Jaypee
Noida City Centre
Noida West

Delhi North

Ashoka
Central Pitampura
Model Town - Chatrasal
Rajouri

East India

Central Kolkata
Odisha North 1

South India

Bangalore South Central
Chennai East

Delhi South

Alaknanda - GK 2
Badkal - Faridabad
C R Park - Kalkaji
Charmwood
Green Park
Lodhi Garden
New Friends Colony
Sainik Farm

Delhi West

Epicentre
Palam Vihar
Shanti Path
Sohna

West India - 2

Chembur - Ghatkopar
Goa
Khar Santacruz BKC

North India

Amritsar
Chandigarh
Jaipur Midtown
Jammu
Lucknow - Gorakhpur
Mohali
Panchkula West

West India - 1

Baner - Central
Goregaon Malad West
Goregaon - Baroda
Kandivali East Dahisar
PCMC - Aundh
Powai Mulund
Pune South
Thane - Kalyan

MEETINGS IN JANUARY 2025

Date	Meeting Type	Responsibility to mark attendance
2 nd Jan 2025	New Year Gongyo and Gosho Meeting	District Statistics Incharge
11 th Jan 2025	Young Phoenix Meeting	Region Statistics Incharge
19 th Jan 2025	District Discussion Meeting	District Statistics Incharge

Let's promptly mark the attendance of the above meetings and report victory as statistics incharges!

HAPPINESS COUNTER



Youth Division

1 4 1 0 7 6



All India

2 8 3 7 9 0

Statistics incharges of BSG make heartfelt determinations, embodying the shared vision of accomplishing the area goals for 2025 and achieving 1 million members by 2030

I am determined to wholeheartedly support the area and BSG targets for 2025, leaving no one behind in my prayers and actions. I will chant abundant daimoku daily for each life on my BDS. I will promptly reach out to all introductions and transfers ensuring smooth transition. I will maintain accurate and updated BDS and create member care plan for each life. Supporting N-1, N-2, and N-3 statistics incharge will remain my priority through home visits, swift action, and encouragement. I am determined to foster unity and realize complete victory in 2025.

Sumit Vakil, Zone Statistics Incharge, West India-2 Area

I am determined take deliberate action as a statistics incharge for my region to expand membership and raise capable successors through daimoku, dialogue and shakubuku. To report victory to Sensei, I will -

- home visit and raise every statistics incharge in my region to take complete ownership of their districts and chapters.
- ensure that attendance is marked immediately.
- diligently work to achieve our shakubuku targets.
- raise the VC subscription with 30 new subscriptions.
- based on my shared vow of mentor & disciple, I commit to create value in each day.

Sharmila Bose, Region Statistics Incharge, West Delhi Area

I am determined to take care, protect and nurture each precious life within our region. I will actively encourage all fellow statistics incharges to swiftly mark attendance, proactively connect with new friends and members, and promptly assign them to their respective districts.

Together, we'll pray for the emergence of new Bodhisattvas of earth within our region, guiding us towards our collective goal of achieving 1 million members by 2030.

Ritu Kumar, Region Statistics Incharge, North Delhi Area

My determination is to -

- 1) Pray to assist my statistics incharges in creative ways and create joy by connecting lives.
- 2) Personally invite N-1 leaders for the discussion and Gosho meeting instead of sending and encourage the same further down.
- 3) Connect with district chiefs and study the spirit of shakubuku, thereby openly discuss the shakubuku targets with the districts.
- 4) Pray along with fellow leaders to focus on 10% growth in discussion meeting attendance month after month.

Abhijit Mahanta , Zone Statistics Incharge, South India Area

In this year 2025, I determine to be a capable disciple of Ikeda Sensei by checking BDS every day, acting with lightning speed on transfers, introductions and Gohonzon applications. I determine to increase region VC and FDT subscriptions to at least 100 VC and 20 FDT, connecting members to Sensei's writings.

By maintaining accurate statistics, I will ensure that at least 2 inactive members in each district are reconnected to faith and practice and not a single life is left behind and, acting as a catalyst in achieving our membership goal in 2025.

Nilanjana Das, Region Statistics Incharge, East India Area

With focus of 2025 being dialogue and shakubuku. I determine to -

- 1) Hold 300 dialogues and do 50 shakubuku.
- 2) Continue to do my human revolution and walk the path of oneness of mentor and disciple.
- 3) With the spirit of reporting absolute victory to Ikeda Sensei, ensure timely and all districts marking attendance.
- 4) Reach out to all friends in BDS through earnest dialogue and daimoku.

Towards 2030, I will raise capable successors and build an age of humanity where there is dignity and respect for each life.

Akshay Munjal, Zone Statistics Incharge, West India-1 Area

Standing in the vanguard, I determine to fight alongside the region, chapter and district statistics incharges in my zone to achieve the target of 570 new members in the zone by 2025.

I determine to create a fresh wave of shakubuku and raise capable leaders.

I determine to make each statistics incharge the key figure who will spearhead the kosen-rufu movement in their respective units. Through united efforts, we will make the goal of one BSG of 1 million members by 2030 a reality!

Manek Ratra, Zone Statistics Incharge, South Delhi Area



ABACUS Editorial Team, in conversation with

Damayanti Bhowmik

Chapter Statistics Incharge, West Delhi Area



Please share your journey of being a statistics incharge?

I first became a statistics incharge when I was a YWD chapter chief and I got this wonderful opportunity again as statistics incharge to advance kosen-rufu in 2021 as a WD district chief.

I have always ensured to mark the attendance on the same day of the meeting and while as CSI, I don't mark the district attendance now, I continue to mark my attendance promptly using the BSG Connect Plus App with the spirit to report victory to Sensei.

Whichever district I am attached to, I diligently try to connect with all WDs and YWDs with the heart of leaving no one behind.



How has being a statistics incharge helped you personally?

I believe being a statistics incharge requires courage. Praying, making a determination and then reaching out to inactive members requires courage. And by doing that, I could create fresh causes in faith. I can say that making causes in life without worrying about the result has made me courageous and I am applying this training in every area of my life.

Moreover, reaching out to members also makes them feel cherished. I wish to continue to spread this warmth in my unit.



Please share your experience of working on new BSG Database

System (BDS) and if any support you may need?

As a statistics incharge, I passionately assist members. In last 2 years, if I may say I have been able to resolve almost 200 queries regarding organisation structure, transfers, introductions etc.

The transition from MDS to BDS was not so difficult. I find BDS very user-friendly.

The training module videos with step wise details are a great help. Also, digitalization of many processes such as Gohonzon application and appointments are much simpler now.



What is the importance of ABACUS for you?

I feel ABACUS is one of the most creative newsletters as every page is insightful. I am sure it takes lot of effort to prepare it. I find puzzle very interesting, and I diligently participate in it.

While I don't read it cover by cover but I am determined to do the same from now on.



What is your determination as statistics incharge in 2025?

It is the daimoku of Ikeda Sensei that so many bodhisattvas have emerged in India. With the same spirit as of my mentor, I am determined to chant daimoku for all those members who have moved away from the practice to come back and make my chapter an example throughout BSG. ●●●

Puzzle for Mathematicians of Happiness



2025 marks significant milestones in the Soka Gakkai's journey. Below is a list of anniversaries and milestones—match each milestone with its corresponding anniversary year. Let's celebrate and reflect on these key moments in our shared history!

Anniversary	Milestones
1) 95th Anniversary	Establishment of SGI
2) 65th Anniversary	Launch of ABACUS
3) 10th Anniversary	Founding of the Soka Gakkai
4) 50th Anniversary	BSG Trailblazers Day and accomplishing 100,000 membership
5) 10th Anniversary	Ikeda Sensei's Inauguration as the 3rd President of Soka Gakkai
6) 5th Anniversary	Formation of BSG Statistics Department

We are looking forward to your answers by
31st January 2025

Please send your answers at
statistics@bharatsokagakkai.org

ANSWERS OF LAST MONTH'S PUZZLE

- | | | | |
|----------|-------------|------------|-----------|
| 1) Devil | 2) Mind | 3) Victory | 4) Goal |
| 5) Study | 6) Fighting | 7) Sword | 8) Person |

LAST MONTH'S PUZZLE WINNERS

- 🏆 Aashu Mittal - North India
- 🏆 Akancha Mondal - Delhi South
- 🏆 Anushka Harwani - North India
- 🏆 Indrani Ghosh - Delhi South
- 🏆 Jaya Chatterjee - East India



- 🏆 Shobha Dube - Delhi North
- 🏆 Sonia Jhingon - West India 1
- 🏆 Sudha Agrawal - South India
- 🏆 Vaskar Chatterjee - Delhi South

OTHER VICTORIOUS COMRADES WHO PARTICIPATED IN THE PUZZLE

- | | |
|---|---|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Akansha Malgani - North India • Ananya Kaushik - North India • Aparna Talukdar - West India 1 • Bharati Dash - East India • Brahma Dutt Shakya - Delhi East • Dr Aanchal Makhija - Delhi South • Dr. Vivek Pandey - North India • Durgeshwari Singh - West India 2 • Gunjan Chachra Bhasin - Delhi East • Juhi Agrawal - North India | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Kareshma Khanna - North India • Kiran Dixit - Delhi East • Kiran Ramchandani - South India • Piyush Saxena - Delhi East • Ram Dular Vishwakarma - Delhi South • Reshma Sao - West India 2 • Richa Jain - West India 1 • S Sampath Kumar - Delhi East • Sunita Bhardwaj - Delhi East • Suniti Sahni - North India |
|---|---|



An introduction can be raised by all Dy. District Chiefs and above through BDS (both from statistics and the view login).



New Friends can be added when marking the attendance of discussion meeting.



A friend automatically becomes a member when their attendance is marked thrice in the BDS (either Discussion or Gosho Meeting).

BDS HELPDESK



In case of any query or assistance on BDS, please write to: helpdesk@bharatsokagakkai.org or create a ticket on BDS under 'Ticket System'.

FEEDBACK



We look forward to hearing from you!

Please write to us if you have any feedback on the newsletter or if you wish to share your experience as statistics incharge; please mail us at : statistics@bharatsokagakkai.org